

MATTY EASTON

matt_easton@berkeley.edu | (801) 662-8410 | linkedin.com/in/matthew-easton

PROFILE

PhD candidate at UC Berkeley with 6+ years delivering data-driven research, stakeholder-facing insights, and team leadership across academic, public sector, and technology environments. Track record of translating complex quantitative findings into clear, actionable recommendations for senior stakeholders. Brings the precision of academic research and the pace of political campaigns to every problem.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Aug 2021 – Present (exp. 2027)

PhD Candidate, Political Science (American Politics; Methodology; Political Behavior) GPA: 3.92/4.00

- Dissertation: Online political socialization via LLM text classification of 50K+ transcripts, network analysis, and survey/field experiments
- Fellowships: Citrin Center for Public Opinion Research | Center for the Study of American Democracy
- Certificates: University of Oxford *Spring School in Quantitative Methods 2026* – Text Analysis and Large Language Modeling

University of California, Berkeley

Apr 2023

MA, Political Science GPA: 3.87/4.00

Brigham Young University

Apr 2019

BA, Political Science (Minor: Professional Writing & Rhetoric) GPA: 4.00/4.00

- Valedictorian, Summa Cum Laude — Phi Kappa Phi & Pi Sigma Alpha Honors

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant — Research Collaborative

Apr 2022 – Present

- Synthesize public opinion research into biweekly briefings for 200+ senior stakeholders across 15+ states; manage research database including data collection, cleaning, analysis, and visualization; contribute to new stakeholder outreach efforts
- Build and scale research infrastructure from the ground up — managing 300+ surveys and focus groups, developing a stakeholder-facing data portal, and growing team capacity from 2 to 7 — to deliver strategic recommendations to partner organizations

Graduate Student Instructor — UC Berkeley, Political Science

Aug 2022 – Aug 2025

- Led instruction across 6 courses including American Politics, U.S. Congress, and U.S. Presidency; taught 300+ students data analysis, analytical writing, and political thought across 12 sections, including one semester as head GSI; recognized with Outstanding GSI Award (2024)
- Managed full course operations including grading 500+ assignments and administering exams; mentored a highly selective scholarship cohort on academics, research, and professional development

Marketing Associate — Eccovia Solutions

Jul 2020 – Jul 2021

- Developed content strategy across 4 digital platforms for a healthcare technology firm; produced weekly client case studies translating complex SaaS capabilities for non-technical audiences; retained as freelancer post-role based on performance

Regional Field Organizer — Pete for America Campaign

Jul 2019 – Feb 2020

- Recruited, trained, and managed 50+ volunteers and 40+ team leads; achieved viability benchmarks (15%+ share) in 75%+ of precincts
- Designed and executed community events for over 900 attendees; led 30+ team trainings and 700+ weekly constituent conversations

Data Analytics Intern — Y2 Analytics

May – Jul 2019

- Executed 10+ market research projects for political, corporate, and municipal clients; designed end-to-end survey research and translated findings into executive-ready presentations with data visualizations

Human Rights Intern to the United Nations — U.S. State Department

Jun – Aug 2018

- Represented U.S. human rights interests at the UN Human Rights Council through NGO stakeholder engagement and council tracking; drafted press releases for the Syria Ceasefire Task Force and Conference on Disarmament

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Broockman, D.E., J.L. Kalla, C. Caballero, & **M. Easton** (2024). “Political Practitioners Poorly Predict Which Messages Persuade the Public.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 121(45), e2400076121.

Easton, M. & J.B. Holbein (2021). “The Democracy of Dating: How Political Affiliations Shape Relationship Formation.” *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, 8(3), 260–272.

SKILLS & TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Quantitative Tools: R, Stata, Qualtrics (survey design & analysis)

Data Visualization: Tableau, Datawrapper, Adobe Illustrator, Google Workspace

Methods: Statistical regression, natural language processing, LLM-assisted text classification, survey/field experiments

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Leadership: Co-President, Political Science Graduate Student Association (2024); President, Political Affairs Society (2019); President, Pi Sigma Alpha (2019); Primary Editor, Sigma Research Journal (2019)

Speaking & Recognition: Equality Utah Young Activist of the Year (2022); Featured Presenter, Encircle Summit (2019); Featured Speaker, LoveLoud Festival (2019); Garth Jones Outstanding Scholar (2018); Mary Lou Fulton Research Grant (2018)